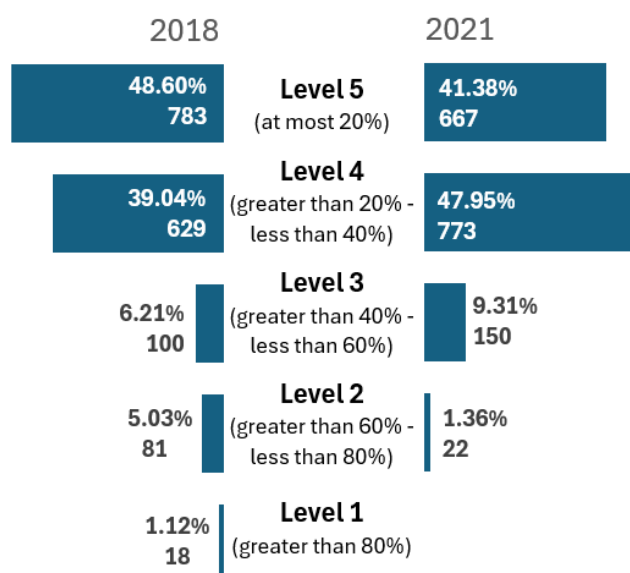


CITY AND MUNICIPAL LEVEL POVERTY ESTIMATES 2018 AND 2021

The poverty situation of cities and municipalities (CMs) generally fared better in 2021 compared to 2018 as there were no local governments falling under Level 1 or those with greater than 80% poverty incidence. But there are fewer Level 5 CMs (or those with at most 20% poverty incidence) at 667 (41.38%) in 2021 compared to 783 (48.60%) in 2018. Poverty estimates were computed for a total of 1,612 cities and municipalities in 2021 and 1,611 in 2018.

FIGURE 1
DISTRIBUTION OF CITIES AND MUNICIPALITIES BY
LEVEL OF POVERTY INCIDENCE ESTIMATES
2018 AND 2021



Note: The Municipality of Palawan was excluded in 2018 since it was a government-regulated island.
Source of data: PSA (2024) Highlights of the 2021 City and Municipal Level of Poverty Estimates

The Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA) released in April 2024 the poverty estimates at the city and municipal level for 2021, excluding data for highly urbanized cities. Consolidated with the results for 2018, PSA generated the estimates based on data from the census, Family Income and Expenditure Surveys (FIES), Updating of the List of Establishments, and Nighttime Lights from the Earth Observation Group.

Level 1. All the 18 Level 1 CMs in 2018 belong to the BARMM (*Table 1*). The CMs were from Lanao del Sur (11), Sulu (5), and Basilan (2). About one in every four CMs in Lanao del Sur and Sulu belonged to Level 1 while for Basilan, the ratio is one in six. The highest incidence was estimated for the Municipality of Pagayawan at 89.6%, which dropped to 20.1% in 2021. All the Level 1

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CMs in 2018 recorded significant reductions in their 2021 estimates.

When comparing the poverty figures, coefficients of variation (CV) should be considered whereby lower CV means higher consistency of estimates. In Lanao del Sur, while there is huge drop in poverty incidence among CMs in 2021 from 2018, note that what used to be single-digit CVs now rose to double figures in 2021. For reference, the “reliable” CV measure should not exceed 10% and caution must be observed for above 20% coefficients (*Table 1*).

TABLE 1
LEVEL 1 CITIES AND MUNICIPALITIES, 2018 AND 2021

	Poverty Incidence among Population (% Estimates)		Coefficient of Variation		
	Year	2018	2021	2018	2021
LANAO DEL SUR					
Pagayawan (Tatarikan)		89.6	20.1	2.9	18.2
Kapai		88.9	17.5	2.7	17.5
Sultan Dumalondong		88.1	31.9	4.9	22.2
Sultan Gumander		86.6	24.7	3.3	19.6
Marogong		86.6	42.2	3.6	10.2
Calanogas		86.1	24.7	3.2	11.9
Kapatagan		85.2	27.3	3.3	20.6
Tagoloan II		85.0	18.9	3.1	15.3
Piagapo		83.9	15.6	2.5	22.4
Lumbaca-Unayan		82.3	24.4	4.7	21.1
Butig		80.7	23.1	5.4	16.3
SULU					
Pata		87.3	57.7	3.8	7.9
Panglima Estino (New Panamao)		85.4	68.3	4.5	5.8
Old Panamao		84.7	50.4	3.5	12.2
Talipao		82.6	54.1	2.4	5.7
Tongkil		80.7	63.0	4.8	9.3
BASILAN					
Tabuan-Lasa		85.9	73.4	4.1	6.2
Hadji Mohammad Ajul		81.6	68.5	6.5	6.6

Source of data: PSA (2024)

Level 2. The 22 Level 2 CMs or the bottom performers in 2021 were from two regions – BARMM and Zamboanga Peninsula (*Table 2*). Of the 18 CMs from BARMM, 11 are from Sulu and seven are from Basilan, while the remaining four are from Zamboanga del Norte. The Municipality of Tabuan-Lasa with 73.4% poverty incidence landed the top spot. Only five CMs registered higher incidences for 2021 vis-à-vis 2018, four of which are from Zamboanga del Norte. See that the CVs for the CMs in Table 2 are at “reliable” levels.

TABLE 2
LEVEL 2 CITIES AND MUNICIPALITIES, 2018 AND 2021

Poverty Incidence among Population (% Estimates)			Coefficient of Variation	
Year	2018	2021	2018	2021
BASILAN				
Tabuan-Lasa	85.9	73.4	4.1	6.2
Hadji Mohammad Ajul	81.6	68.5	6.5	6.6
Hadji Muhtamad	75.2	67.6	5.9	8.1
Al-barka	73.6	67.3	5.0	5.7
Akbar	70.1	64.9	9.4	9.3
Tipo-Tipo	76.6	62.3	5.3	5.9
Tuburan	75.5	61.8	6.9	7.7
SULU				
Tapul	76.8	70.7	4.9	6.0
Parang	77.2	69.7	2.9	7.3
Omar	79.4	68.5	6.1	8.2
Panglima Estino (New Panamao)	85.4	68.3	4.5	5.8
Hadji Panglima Tahil (Marunggas)	78.5	64.1	7.9	5.4
Tongkil	80.7	63.0	4.8	9.3
Pangutaran	76.8	62.3	4.8	4.8
Pandami	70.1	61.9	6.5	8.0
Kalingalan Caluang	78.7	61.4	6.3	9.5
Patikul	59.1	61.2	7.4	9.4
Lugus	75.5	61.2	5.3	7.9
ZAMBOANGA DEL NORTE				
Siayan	62.0	67.0	6.0	4.0
Baliguian	52.6	63.7	7.7	5.3
Sirawai	57.6	62.7	8.4	5.6
Sergio Osmeña Sr.	59.2	60.8	4.3	4.5

Source of data: PSA (2024)

Consistently high poverty incidence, 2018 and 2021. Two municipalities each from Basilan and Sulu belonged to the poorest performers for both 2018 and 2021. These are Tabuan-Lasa, Hadji Mohammad Ajul, Panglima Estino, and Tongkil. Even with two-digit percentage declines, their poverty incidence rates still ranged from 63.0% to 73.4% in 2021. (See rows with blue background in Tables 1 and 2)

Levels 3, 4, 5. There are 1,512 CMs in 2018, and 1,590 in 2021, with levels 3 to 5 poverty estimates (*Table 3*). More than a majority of those under Level 3 are from Mindanao. On the other hand, between 73.6% (2018) to 79.8% (2021) of the best performers (Level 5) are from Luzon.

All island groups recorded an increase in the number of CMs in Levels 3 and 4 between 2018 and 2021. On the other hand, Level 5 CMs declined from 783 in 2018 to 667 in 2021 with all island groups contributing to the drop in performance.

TABLE 3
DISTRIBUTION OF LEVELS 3, 4, AND 5 CITIES AND MUNICIPALITIES BY MAJOR ISLAND GROUP 2018 AND 2021

Level of Poverty Incidence Estimated, 2018 & 2021		Luzon	Visayas	Mindanao	Sub-totals
3: greater than 40% but less than 60%	2018	6	29	65	100
	2021	19	30	101	150
4: greater than 20% but less than 40%	2018	180	230	219	629
	2021	212	284	277	773
5: at most 20%	2018	576	141	66	783
	2021	532	88	47	667
Sub-totals	2018	762	400	350	1,512
	2021	763	402	425	1,590

Source of data: PSA (2024)

Level 5. There were 116 CMs which were dropped from Level 5 in 2021 compared with the 2018 figures. Nearly half or 44.8% are from Central Visayas (30) and Western Visayas (22) (*Table 4*). Northern Mindanao contributed 27 more. Only four regions posted increases – CAR, Cagayan Valley, Davao Region, and BARMM. Three other regions maintained their 2018 distribution – NCR, Zamboanga Peninsula and SoCCSKSarGen.

TABLE 4
DISTRIBUTION OF LEVEL 5 CITIES AND MUNICIPALITIES BY REGION, 2018 AND 2021

Region	2018	2021	Diff
NCR	14	14	0
CAR	44	61	17
I: Ilocos	125	107	-18
II: Cagayan Valley	73	85	12
III: Central Luzon	128	109	-19
IV-A: CaLaBarZon	128	117	-11
IV-B: MiMaRoPa	48	31	-17
V: Bicol	16	8	-8
VI: Western Visayas	79	57	-22
VII: Central Visayas	57	27	-30
VIII: Eastern Visayas	5	4	-1
IX: Zamboanga Peninsula	3	3	0
X: Northern Mindanao	29	2	-27
XI: Davao Region	17	24	7
XII: SoCCSKSarGen	7	7	0
XIII: Caraga	4	0	-4
BARMM	6	11	5
Sub-totals	783	667	-116

Source of data: PSA (2024)